Jan-Willem Simons

Academic Curriculum Vitae in October 2026

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Interests

Interethnic relations; Social influence; Socialisation; Media effects; Social norms; Tolerance; Negative social relations; Systematic reviews and meta-analyses; Agent-based models; Social network analysis; Stochastic actor-oriented models; Exponential random graph models; Hidden Markov models

Education

Utrecht University, The Netherlands — October 2021 – October 2026 (expected)
PhD Candidate in Sociology
Graduate school: Interuniversity Center for Social Science Theory and Methodology (ICS)
Thesis (working title): *It Depends, but on What? Social Influence, Tolerance and the Study of Interethnic Relations*
Advisors: Prof. Dr. Eva Jaspers (Utrecht University) and Prof. Dr. Frank van Tubergen (Utrecht University)

Utrecht University, The Netherlands — September 2019 – July 2021
M.Sc. in Methodology and Statistics for the Behavioural, Biomedical, and Social Sciences
Thesis: *On the Analysis of a Sample of Exponential Random Graph Model Estimates*
Advisor: Prof. Dr. Marijtje van Duijn (University of Groningen)

Utrecht University, The Netherlands — September 2016 – July 2019
B.Sc. in Sociology with a Minor in Methods and Statistics
Thesis: *Examining the Effect of Observation Sequence Variables on Hidden Markov Model Gibbs Sampler Inference*
Advisor: Dr. Emmeke Aarts (Utrecht University)
Additional Activities: Honours College Faculty of Social Sciences

Peer-Reviewed Publications

[7] Schäfer, L. F., Tausch, N., Bukowski, M., Jaspers, E., Lubbers, M. J., Van Zalk, M., Ciorda, A., Potoczek, A., Estevan-Reina, L., Shani, M., **Simons, J.-W.**, Friehs, M. T., Gurbisz, D., Middendorf, W. M., Schäfer, S. J., Ullenboom, J., Graf, S., Hjerm, M., Lavest, C., Jasinskaja-Lahti, I., Kende, A., Petkanopoulou, K., Prati, F., & Christ, O. (2026). Associations between inclusivity norms and tolerance, contact, and cooperation amid polarization: Evidence from 12 European countries. *PNAS Nexus*, pgag087. https://doi.org/10.1093/pnasnexus/pgag087

[6] **Simons, J.-W.**, Jaspers, E., & van Tubergen, F. (2026). Media influences on ethnic majority attitudes toward ethnic minorities: A systematic review and meta-analysis. *International Journal of Intercultural Relations, 110*, Article 102320. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.ijintrel.2025.102320

[5] Heo, I., **Simons, J.-W.**, & Liu, H. (2025). A tutorial on Bayesian model averaging for exponential random graph models. *British Journal of Mathematical and Statistical Psychology*. Advance online publication. https://doi.org/10.1111/bmsp.70007

[4] Jaspers, E., Van Zantvliet, P. I., & **Simons, J.-W.** (2025). How descriptive norms and peer attitudes shape interethnic dating among adolescents in Dutch schools. *Social Inclusion, 13*. https://doi.org/10.17645/si.10034

[3] **Simons, J.-W.**, Jaspers, E., & van Tubergen, F. (2025). Socialisation and ethnic majorities' attitudes towards ethnic minorities: A systematic review and meta-analysis of correlational evidence. *Journal of Ethnic and Migration Studies, 51*(11), 2669–2694. https://doi.org/10.1080/1369183X.2025.2472818

[2] **Simons, J.-W.**, Boverhof, B.-J., & Aarts, E. (2024). The influence of observation sequence features on the performance of the Bayesian hidden Markov model: A Monte Carlo simulation study. *PloS One, 19*(12), e0314444. https://doi.org/10.1371/journal.pone.0314444

[1] Goossens, C., & **Simons, J.-W.** (2024). Overbruggen van denkbeelden en grenzen: De effecten van opleidingsniveau op anti-immigratie attituden in West-en Oost-Europa. *Mens & Maatschappij, 99*(1), 33-61. https://doi.org/10.5117/MEM2024.1.003.GOOS

Preprints

[1] Ciorda, A., Lubbers, M., Jaspers, E., & **Simons, J.-W.** (2025). Not all political topics are created equal: How issue polarization shapes partner selection in informal political discussion. https://doi.org/10.31235/osf.io/zauq4_v1

Working Papers

[3] **Simons, J.-W.**, Tolsma, J., Jaspers, E., & Middendorf, W. M. Does tolerance improve interethnic relations? A longitudinal social network study in two diverse German high schools.

[2] **Simons, J.-W.**, & van Duijn, M. A. J. On the analysis of a sample of exponential random graph model estimates.

[1] **Simons, J.-W.**, & Jaspers, E. Balance, status, and avoidance: On the role of propinquity for shaping social network dynamics.

Conference Presentations

[5] Heo, I. (presenter), **Simons, J.-W.**, & Liu, H. *A Bayesian multi-model inferential approach to exponential random graph modeling* [Poster Presentation]. 133rd Annual Convention of the American Psychological Association. Denver, The United States of America. August, 2025.

[4] **Simons, J.-W.** (presenter), Tolsma. J., Jaspers, E. *On the Design of a Social Norm Intervention to Promote Interethnic Cooperation through Tolerance: An Agent-Based Model* [Conference Presentation]. 5th ISA Forum of Sociology. Rabat, Morocco. July, 2025.

[3] **Simons, J.-W.** (presenter), Tolsma. J., Jaspers, E. *On the Design of a Social Norm Intervention to Promote Interethnic Cooperation through Tolerance: An Agent-Based Model* [Conference Presentation]. Interdisciplinary Conference on Social Norms, Cohesion, and (De)Polarization. Utrecht, The Netherlands. May, 2025.

[2] **Simons, J.-W.** (presenter), Jaspers, E. *Balance, Status, and Negative Tie Dynamics in A High Propinquity Network Context* [Conference Presentation]. European Conference of Social Networks. Ljubljana, Slovenia. September, 2023.

[1] **Simons, J.-W.** (presenter), Van Duijn, M. A. J. *On the Analysis of a Sample of Exponential Random Graph Model Estimates* [Conference Presentation]. European Conference of Social Networks. Online. September, 2021.

Research Visits

Autonomous University of Barcelona — Barcelona, Spain
Visiting PhD Researcher, COALESCE Lab — April – July 2023
Collaborator: Professor Miranda Lubbers

Training

13th Winter School on Longitudinal Social Network Analysis
Including the Advanced Siena Users' Meeting (AdSUM 2023)
ICS, University of Groningen, Groningen, The Netherlands — January – February 2023

CNRS Thematic School ABM-SOC-NET: Agent-Based Modeling in Sociology
CNRS, Fréjus, France — November 2021

Service to the Profession

Ad-hoc Peer Review
PLOS ONE (2 reviews for 1 manuscript, 2025-2026)
Social Sciences & Humanities Open (2 reviews for 1 manuscript, 2026)

Memberships

International Sociological Association (ISA), Research Committee 45: Micro-Macro Modelling

Teaching Experience

Tutorial group teaching October 2021 – October 2024
Department of Sociology, Utrecht University
Activities: Taught a tutorial group each second semester from 2021 to 2024 for the course "Social Networks in Theory and Empirical Research".

Bachelor thesis supervision October 2022 – October 2025
Department of Sociology, Utrecht University
Activities: Supervised groups of 3–5 sociology bachelor's students in writing their thesis projects during the second semester of the academic years 2022–2025.

Skills and Proficiencies

Statistical Software
R (RStudio, Markdown, Shiny), NetLogo, Python, LaTeX, Git, M*plus*, SPSS

Language Ability
Native in Dutch, Near native in English, Beginner in French and German